

Karis Fellowships *Neurosis and Human Growth* Book Study Syllabus and Overview

Life is difficult, but it can be much less difficult if we are willing to grow out of our neurosis. Neurosis is another word for the system of unconscious motives that drive our unhealthy outcomes. The Bible shows us how we perpetuate unhealthy outcomes through our pride, sin, and fear. The NHG study is also difficult, but not as difficult as living a neurotic life. This study brings with it tremendous rewards as you begin to understand yourself and your choices, and the choices of others. It is the wise person who works to understand his own way (Proverbs 14:8). Understanding leads to compassion, and I hope that as you read this book you will feel some compassion for yourself.

It is difficult to change our behavior, but it can be excruciating to change our identity. Many factors have caused us to adopt an identity which we hoped would help us survive. That identity became hardened and inflexible as our anxiety increased. In an effort to allay our anxiety, we developed a pride system as a substitute for real peaceful self-confidence. Perhaps we are ready to see that this rigid identity actually adds to our problems. We might now be willing to grow out of the compelling need to protect our pride and suppress our fears so that we can learn how to live in all the potential of our true created design and calling.

In his letter to the Galatians, Paul encourages us to walk by the Spirit and stop fulfilling the cravings of our flesh. Through the NHG book study we will begin to see how our neurosis is a product of the flesh that disconnects us from God. When we are disconnected from God, it is impossible to produce the fruit of God's Spirit (Galatians 5:16-25). I wonder if you have ever asked yourself questions like these:

- Why am I unable to consistently love in the way that Paul describes in 1 Corinthians 13?
- Why do my relationships lack the spontaneous peace and harmony that are hallmarks of a Christian community?
- Where does this anxiety, confusion, or rage come from?
- What causes me to undermine or sabotage myself?
- Why do I constantly find myself judging everyone and everything?
- What blocks me from enjoying a meaningful and abundant relationship with God?

The NHG Book Study and Karis Fellowships training are designed to help you find answers to these kinds of questions.

Karis Fellowships is a one-year training program designed to equip and support you as you begin investing in the person God created you to be. KF members attend small online meetings that help them examine and ground themselves through sharing, Bible teaching, skill development, and healing. It is essential that members of Karis Fellowships are acquainted with NHG ideas and, also, that they show a real intention to change their lives. This book study is a great place to explore our intentions!

Nancy Diven, Founder of Karis Fellowships

NHG Study Goal

The NHG reading guides efficiently lead us through this somewhat difficult book. Our goal is to simply get through the material and attend the meetings. Knowing the ideas presented in the material is not the same as learning to live a new life, but it is a start. The reading guides help us focus our thoughts, consider the key NHG concepts, and keep us on schedule.

How Does Karis Fellowships Operate?

Karis Fellowships is an organization that is run entirely by volunteers who are learning to live with more connection to the Spirit of God. Their work is an expression of gratitude for what KF training has done for them. Karis Fellowships is an effort-based ministry, not a need-based ministry. Let me repeat that. Karis Fellowships is an effort-based ministry, not a need-based ministry. In KF we support each other in our efforts to take responsibility for the quality of our own lives. We are not here to persuade, advise, prop up, or rescue. We honor your choices as real evidence of your intentions, even when those intentions do not include the aim of KF! Perhaps you have been evaluating the outcome of some of your choices. You may or may not want to try something new, but I hope that at least you are willing to explore what is possible through this study. Who knows? This study may be just what you have been looking for.

If you register for Karis Fellowships but find that KF training is not for you, please let admin know and simply withdraw. You will have the opportunity to re-evaluate and begin the training cycle again the following year.

KF Policy

To be eligible for KF membership you must:

1. Attend 7 out of the 8 weekly group meetings, or 5 out of the 6 Weekend Intensive meetings.
You can make up any chapter studies that you missed during the weekly meetings by joining that chapter study at the Weekend Intensive. In special circumstances, students can make up one missed live meeting by listening to the recording.
2. Complete 10 out of the 11 study guides.

Attendance and completed reading guides are recorded on the **NHG Attendance Template** by facilitators.

Course Materials

We use the 1991 edition of *Neurosis and Human Growth: The Struggle toward Self-Realization* by Karen Horney. The KF Chapter Reading Guides are coded to this edition. Here are some options.

- [Amazon.com](https://www.amazon.com) or another online retailer; price hovers between \$13 - \$18.
- Public library, plan to use the book for at least 8 weeks.
- [Audible.com](https://www.audible.com) We recommend an audio version to use as a supplement; first-time members get one audiobook free.
- Download a free, legal PDF from the Karis Fellowships (KF) website. Click on **Start Here** under the **NHG** tab.

Chapter Reading Guides

- To access the reading guides, click on **Schedule and Reading Guides** under the **NHG** tab.
- The notation next to each question indicates where you will find the answer to that question. For example, 39.4 tells you that the answer is on page 39, paragraph 4.
- Questions use the same wording as Dr. Horney's text to make finding the answers easier.
- Most participants answer questions as they read the chapter. They often spend **2 to 3 hours** completing each reading guide. Give yourself permission to stop filling in answers at the end of 3 hours, but try to finish reading the chapter.
- If you can't find the answer, just skip the question. Fill in the answer at the meeting.

Chapter Intros

These Intros give an overview of the chapters and correlate Biblical truth with Dr. Horney's theory of human development.

Contact

If you get stuck, have a question or want to vent, reach out to your Karis Link – the person who invited you to this study. You can also reach out to us at nhg@karisfellowships.com and one of the KF volunteers will try to help.

NHG Book Study Schedule

Each week students read the assigned chapter(s) along with the KF Intro(s) and complete the corresponding reading guides. The meeting generally lasts 90 minutes when we study one chapter and two hours when we study two chapters. The Weekly Study groups meet once a week for 8 weeks. The Weekend Intensive group meets 6 times over a weekend. You will find the exact dates and times of the meetings on the KF website under the **NHG** tab in **Schedule and Reading Guides** and **Attend NHG Meetings**.

Introductory Week

1. Read the NHG information and encouragement emails.
2. Order your book, if you haven't already.
3. Become familiar with the NHG material, policy and guidelines.
4. Start reading and working on the Reading Guide for the Intro & Chapter 1 (26 Pages, 2-3 hours). We recommend beginning Chapters 2 & 3 if you can. These chapters for next week are the longest assignment and will require more time.
5. Put the Weekend Intensive NHG Study on your calendar in case you need to make up lessons. The exact times are on the KF website.

Week 1

1. Read NHG information and encouragement emails.
2. Read NHG Introduction and Chapter 1: *The Search for Glory*.
3. Read KF Chapter 1 Introduction.
4. Complete Reading Guide.

Week 2

1. Read NHG information and encouragement emails.
2. Read NHG Chapter 2: *Neurotic Claims* and Chapter 3: *The Tyranny of the Should*.
3. Read KF Chapter 2 and 3 Introductions.
4. Complete Reading Guides.

Week 3

1. Read NHG information and encouragement emails.
2. Read NHG Chapter 4: *Neurotic Pride*.
3. Read KF Chapter 4 Introduction.
4. Complete Reading Guide.
5. Download and print document: *Love or Pride?* (found in Week 3 on KF website).

Week 4

1. Read NHG information and encouragement emails.
2. Read NHG Chapter 5: *Self-Hate and Self-Contempt*.
3. Read KF Chapter 5 Introductions.
4. Complete Reading Guide.

Week 5

1. Read NHG information and encouragement emails.
2. Read NHG Chapter 6: *Alienation from Self*.
3. Read KF Chapter 6 Introduction.
4. Complete Reading Guide.

Week 6

1. Read NHG information and encouragement emails.
2. Read NHG Chapters 7: *General Measures* and Chapter 8: *Expansive Solution*.
3. Read KF Chapter 7 and 8 Introductions.
4. Complete Reading Guides.

Week 7

1. Read NHG information and encouragement emails.
2. Read NHG Chapters 9: *The Self-Effacing Solution* and 10: *Morbid Dependence*.
3. Read KF Chapter 9 and 10 Introductions.
4. Complete Reading Guides.

Week 8

1. Read NHG information and encouragement emails.
2. Read NHG Chapter 11: *Resignation*.
3. Read KF Chapter 11 Introduction.
4. Complete Reading Guide.
5. Answer any questions that interest you on the NHG Book Study Review.

Weekend Intensive (exact date and time on website)

Please match the CST meeting times with your particular time zone. Hopefully, you have been keeping up with the reading schedule during the last eight weeks.

FRIDAY

Meeting 1: Chapters 1 & 2 7 p.m. – 9 p.m. CST

SATURDAY

Meeting 2: Chapters 3 & 4 8 a.m. – 10 a.m. CST

Meeting 3: Chapters 5 & 6 11 a.m. – 1 p.m. CST

Meeting 4: Chapters 7 & 8 7 p.m. – 9 p.m. CST

SUNDAY

Meeting 5: Chapters 9 & 10 3 p.m. – 5 p.m. CST

Meeting 6: Chapters 11 & Review 7 p.m. – 9 p.m. CST

KF Introductory Meeting (exact date and time on website)

Optional KF Introductory Meeting for all NHG graduates (1.5 hour meeting).

Download and print the documents for the meeting from the NHG Schedule and Reading Guides on the KF website.

Guidelines for NHG Meetings

Working together over the phone and online presents some extra challenges. When we are on audio-only calls, we miss some of the communication signals that we might notice while talking face to face. So, to help the meetings flow efficiently and in a timely manner, we have developed guidelines for the NHG study. Some of these guidelines have been taken from Karis Fellowships training.

- **We cooperate** for the security and efficiency of the group.
- **We adhere** to the time restraints (so NHG meetings don't run overtime).
- **We present** ourselves authentically.
- **We hold** in sacred confidence what we learn about each other.
- **We withhold** opinions on outside issues while in the meeting.
- **We take turns** speaking and answering as the facilitator directs us.
- **We respect** the facilitators and follow their guidance.
- **We support** the goal of finishing the Reading Guide for each chapter.
- **We offer** our own thoughts and experience during the free discussion time.
- **We avoid** correcting or embellishing the thoughts of others.

Meeting Format

The meetings have 3 parts:

1. We introduce the material from a Christian perspective.
2. The facilitator guides participants to take turns sharing their answers to the questions on the reading guide.
3. We pause often for questions and comments.

How to call into a Meeting

- We use a conference call service called StartMeeting. Follow these steps with a landline, cell phone, Skype, or other provider:
- Make sure you're calling at the right time for your time zone. Begin about 3 minutes before the meeting starts.
- See "Attend NHG Meetings" under the NHG tab on the website.

Prepare For The First Meeting

- Remember to ignore the automated prompt to announce yourself
- In the meeting, the facilitator will ask each person to briefly introduce themselves by sharing their first name and general location and by giving a quick answer to a general question.
- We will go through all the answers to the first Reading Guide at the first meeting.
- The facilitator assigns students to break-out groups (subgroups).
- All attendance and participation is recorded by the facilitators.

We look forward to hearing your voice soon! If you have any questions or comments, please let your Karis Link know, or email us at nhg@karisfellowships.com

The KF-NHG Admin Team

This book study overview refers to the 1991 edition of *Neurosis and Human Growth: The Struggle Toward Self-Realization* by Karen Horney, published by W.W. Norton and Company Inc. New York.